Theme 3: Tourism and Hospitality

Service With a Smile (Complaining & responding)

Lesson 3-4
Book pages 40-41

💡 **Big idea:** We listen to a conversation at the **Oman Tourism College** and a hotel guest **complaining** about his room. We learn polite phrases to **complain** and to **respond to complaints**, and discuss problems a tour guide might face.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Listen for specific information
- Make polite complaints
- Respond to complaints and apologise
- Solve problems in tourism situations

📖 Key words

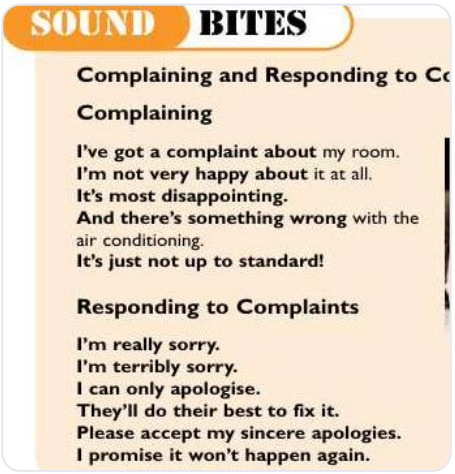
complaint شكوى	**apologise** يعتذر	**disappointing** مخيب للآمال	**up to standard** بالمستوى المطلوب
receptionist موظف الاستقبال	**diploma** دبلوم	**food poisoning** تسمم غذائي	

Soundbites: complaining

- I've got a complaint about my room.
- I'm not very happy about it at all.
- It's most disappointing.
- There's something wrong with the air conditioning.
- It's just not up to standard!

Soundbites: responding

- I'm really sorry. / I'm terribly sorry.
- I can only apologise.
- They'll do their best to fix it.
- Please accept my sincere apologies.
- I promise it won't happen again.


SOUND BITES

Complaining and Responding to Co

Complaining

I've got a complaint about my room.
I'm not very happy about it at all.
It's most disappointing.
And there's something wrong with the air conditioning.
It's just not up to standard!

Responding to Complaints

I'm really sorry.
I'm terribly sorry.
I can only apologise.
They'll do their best to fix it.
Please accept my sincere apologies.
I promise it won't happen again.

Soundbites: complaining and responding to complaints (p.41)

✏️ Examples

Complain about slow service in a restaurant.

Answer: I'm not very happy about the service at all; we have waited for an hour.

Respond to a guest's complaint.

Answer: I'm terribly sorry. We'll fix it right away. I promise it won't happen again.

⭐ Remember

- Stay calm and polite when you complain: describe the problem and say what you want.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ Your hotel is terrible, fix it now! ✓ I've got a complaint about my room
- the air conditioning isn't working.

🧩 **Activity:** Role-play: a passenger whose suitcase is lost complains to an airline representative.

✅ Check yourself

1. Polite phrase to complain
2. Polite phrase to apologise
3. What does 'up to standard' mean?
4. What does a receptionist do?

Answers: (1) I've got a complaint about… ، (2) Please accept my sincere apologies ، (3) good enough ، (4) welcomes guests and deals with their requests